

AMD pokes Intel

Driven to the point of the sword, AMD got some much needed respite with Intel's 6 series SATA woes and their marketing campaign taunts Intel to this effect

Intel to ship 10 core CPU

Intel's spokesperson said that their upcoming Westmere EX Xeon processor is expected to ship soon, definitely in the first half of 2011

from the lid carried over inside, and especially on the palm rest. While it's reasonably well built, Zenith has cut corners in obvious regions. We noticed the left side of the palm rest tends to get hot after using for more than two hours. The recessed USB ports on the right are a pain while inserting devices – an example of usability foregone for style.

The next notebook we looked at was a heavyweight. At 2.6 kilograms, and with a display size of 15.6 inches, the Acer 5742G is definitely not the sort of machine you'll want to tote around a lot. The matte black texture that does duty on the exterior also extends to the inside. The 5742G is well built and looks rather suave – the floating keypad works very well. The trackpad while featuring pinch zooming isn't as accurate as we'd like. One of the "features" of this notebook was the presence of a dedicated graphic solution – and that too a DX11 solution – a GeForce GT 540M. The only other notebook that featured dedicated graphics was the ASUS X52J with the AMD Radeon HD 6370M. The X52J is an attractive notebook with a bright red lid with attractive graphics. The ASUS logo is embossed in steel – an attractive touch. The Radeon

HD 6370 graphics and Core i3 processor ensure it's no slouch, while the large, flat keys ensure high points in the usability department. The keys have good tactile feedback, and this aids usability. Biometrics login is supported via facial recognition, and the trackpad incorporates basic gesture-based controls.

The other 15.6-inch monster is the ASUS P52F – which has a much faster

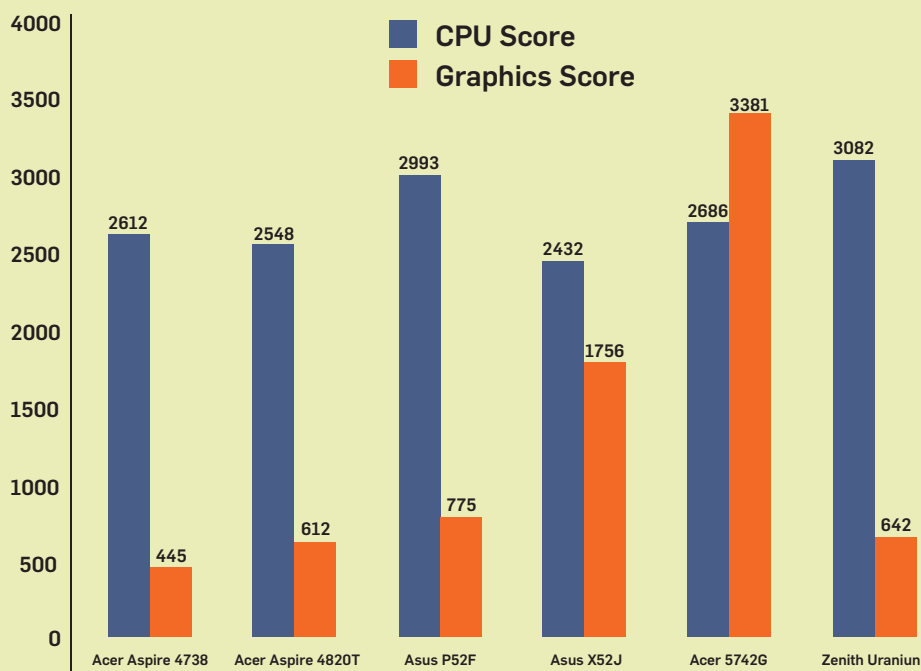
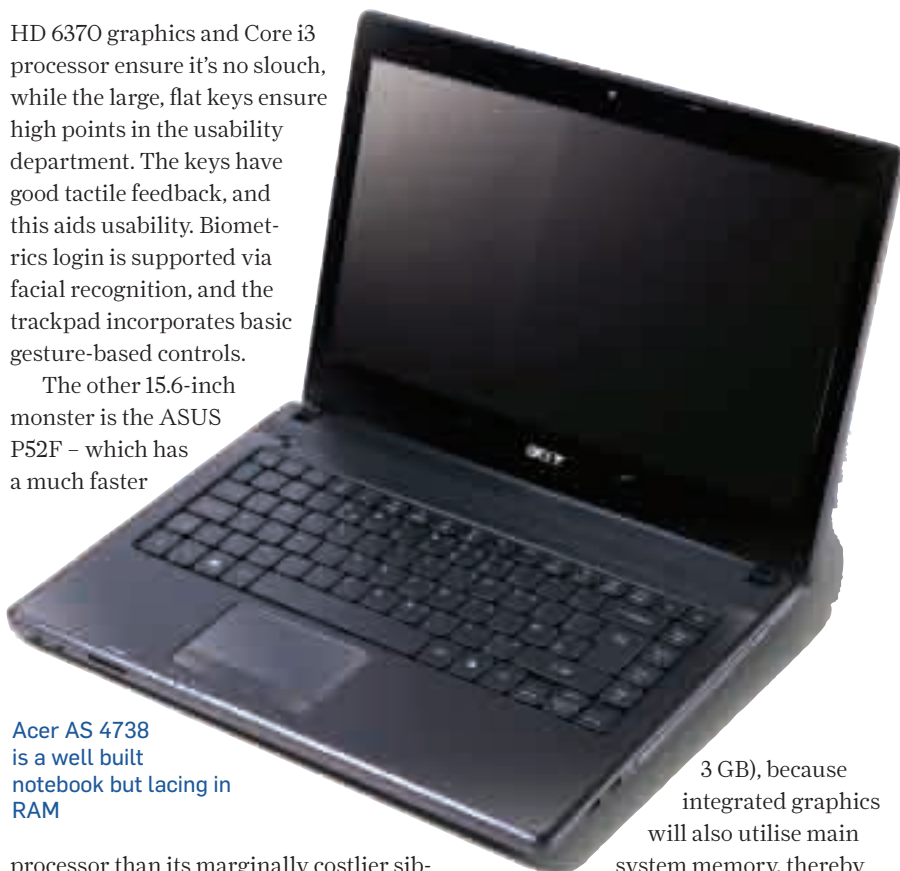
Acer AS 4738 is a well built notebook but lacking in RAM

processor than its marginally costlier sibling, but makes do with integrated (Intel) graphics. We're pleased ASUS upped the RAM by 1 GB to 4 GB, (the X52J has

3 GB), because integrated graphics will also utilise main system memory, thereby leaving less memory for OS and application use. Looks wise, the P52F is a bit different from the X52J – matte black with texturing does duty in place of the glossy finish. The P52F's design seems to be reminiscent of the ASUS Bamboo series, if not on the use of materials, then on the overall look and placement of elements. One of the sure indications of the corporate nature of this notebook (in case the finish wasn't clue enough) is the presence of hard drive protection, by means of cushioning built into the notebook that protects the drive from sharp impacts.

Performance

When it comes to performance, there will always be a divide between notebooks with discrete graphic solutions and those with integrated solutions. While gaming on a sub ₹40,000 notebook may be considered foolhardy by some, the two solutions with discrete graphics can handle the odd game. That is not to say we recommend them for gaming, and a desktop worth the same amount will surely give you more bang for buck, but it's to be noted that they have strong multimedia



3D Mark 2006 score : Most of the notebooks which didn't have a discrete graphics solution gave similar graphics score except ASUS X52J and Acer 5742G